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June 24, 2021

Written Assignment 2

1. **In the Middle Ages, the Catholic Church predominated in almost every aspect of life, and the Catholic Mass was an integral part of church activities. Did the Catholic Church, particularly the Mass, have any impact on music? How?**
   - During the Middle Ages, Catholic Church started to make systematic use of musical notation. Church music was the highest type of music, and those who composed it were the most accomplished musicians, and they have frequently sung about religious topics. Secular music was distinct in that it incorporated elements such as dance or witty lyrics, and the church attempted to outlaw it on the grounds that it was blasphemous. Based on the text, it concludes that reformers believed that monophonic congregational singing in the vernacular should define Christian worship, while Catholic prefered trained singer and polyphony.
2. **Sacred music in the Middle Ages was mostly vocal in nature with little instrumental use, if at all. Was this approach also true of Secular music? Explain your answer.**
   - Sacred music is associated with religious or expanded approaches to sung spiritual worship. Sacred music only focuses on religious aspects with more lines of crusades, dancing but it had few limited theme songs. Secular music is everything else including social music-making for entertainment and personal expression. Medieval and Renaissance instruments, used primarily for secular music, were categorized as loud such as drums, harps, bagpipes, etc. So, it is clear that secular music had a lot of use of instruments when compared to sacred music.
3. **The Renaissance ushered in many changes in art, music, religion, and culture. Many of these elements were blended in very creative ways. How did Renaissance composers achieve a union of words and music?**
   - Music was a basic piece of city, strict, and dignified life in the Renaissance. With the rise of Renaissance polyphony, composers concentrated their musical settings on the ordinary. In the matter of harmony, composers of the Renaissance leaned toward fuller chords. One of the most popular genres was the motet, it is the ability to combine newly written texts of praise with prescribed prayers.
4. **List and explain *at least three* popular sixteenth century dance types, including the style, common instrumentation, and use in court, society, or both.**
   - Basse danse was a popular court dance that took place in Burgundian Courts, where people glided slowly and gracefully without having their feet leave the floor. Dancers usually follow the melody 6/4 and 3/2 time. There were four types of steps: pas simple, pas double, demarche, and branle.

- Pavane originated in Italy, and was a Spanish-influenced court in the 16th century. It is in slow duple meter (2/2 time), and follows a form of A, A1, B, B1, C, C1; using counterpoint accompaniment. The Performers wore complex clothing and danced to drums. This type of dance is paired with Galliard dance and commonly used in weddings.
- Almain (also called as allemande) is one of the most well known forms of Baroque music. It was an instrumental dance, which formed the first movement of the suite followed by the Courante. Almain is a duple meter, derived from dances in Germany with the upbeat of two or occasionally three sixteenth notes.

5. **The Baroque period gave birth to a new musical genre: opera. What are the main dramatic and musical elements of Baroque opera? Be sure to discuss musical, dramatic, and visual elements utilized during this period.**
   - The lute, harpsichord, and contrabassoon are among the strange and fantastic instruments that frequently appear in a baroque ensemble. Baroque opera's plots range from heartbreaking drama to hysterical comedy, and are frequently based on Greek and Roman mythology. Musicians were familiar with the basic harmonies, the composer put a numeral above or below the bass note, indicating the chord required (a kind of notation called figured bass), and the performer filled in the necessary harmony. This system, known as basso continuo, provided a foundation over which a vocal or instrumental melody could unfold. It led to one of the most significant changes in all music history: the establishment of major minor tonality. Dramatic elements of baroque opera combined various elements of poetry and drama.Visual elements are generally incorporated scenery and costumes, and even dance through valleys. Opera is a hybrid of various art forms. Opera's usage of numerous art forms contributes significantly to its appeal. Opera is a unique art form that blends singing, acting, symphonic music, poetry, dance, mime, theatrical scenery, costumes, and lighting.
6. **Why do audiences in America traditionally rise for the Hallelujah Chorus in Handel's Messiah? You may not find this in the text, but information is available online. Be specific in historical facts.**
   - King George II attended the London premier and allegedly rose to his feet during the "Hallelujah Chorus" during a royal performance of Messiah in March of 1743. When the king stood up, everyone else in the room had to stand up as well. In 1770, the Hallelujah Chorus was introduced to America, and it quickly spread over the Eastern United States. The chorus had already become the most popular finishing piece for choral concerts in America's musical cities by the time the whole oratorio arrived in Boston in 1818. A shift in Christmas celebrations occurred shortly after the premiere of Messiah. These revisions aided the popularity of Messiah's seasonal performances, quickly transforming it into a Christmas oratorio.